Spot the Misleading Chart

Student worksheet · Beginner level

Name:	Class:	Date:

Every chart tells a story. A good chart tells a **true** story you can see at a glance. Use this sheet with the *Good Charts vs Bad Charts* website, set to the same level.

Part 1: Match each mistake to its rule

Write the letter of the rule that fixes each mistake.

Mistake	Letter	Rule
1. Bars that don't start at zero		**A.** Up on the chart should mean more.
2. Colors that don't mean anything		**B.** Bar charts always start at zero.
3. A pie chart with lots of slices		**C.** To compare lots of things, use sorted bars.
4. An upside-down axis		**D.** A new color should mean a new group.

Part 2: Take the quiz

Do the quiz on the website. Write your score, then the rule you found hardest and why.

My score:	out of 4
Hardest rule and why:	

Part 3: Words to know

Draw a line from each word to what it means.

Word	Meaning
Axis	A. One sentence that sums up a chart's story
Legend	B. The scale along the side or bottom of a chart
Headline	C. A number written right on the chart
Data label	D. The key that tells you what each color means

Part 4: Find a chart in the real world

Find a chart in a newspaper, website or textbook.

Where I found it:
I notice… (What do I see first?)
I wonder… (What questions do I have?)
Its headline in one sentence:

Now check:

Question	What I noticed
Do the bars start at zero? If it's not a bar chart, write “not bars.”	
What do the colors mean? Is there a reason for each color?	
Is it easy to read? Could you find the answer fast?	

Is this chart honest? [ ] Yes [ ] No [ ] Not sure
Draw a better version with your own headline on top: